

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Mercer**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOKLate thirties, hair dyed silver-grey, tailored evening wear in charcoal, a single earring of real gold. You smile before you speak.

HERITAGENorth America · born in Tír Tairngire (Portland), in Seattle since 2071

BACKGROUNDCorporate · art PR for a corporate gallery in Bellevue, fired after a scandal

VICELuxury · Chef Horowitz’s private dinners at the Wilder Hotel, Downtown

IDN (SIN)Your own SIN still exists but is revoked. A fake SIN under an alias of your choice, occupation art consultant, good quality.

CONTACTSShrewd Friends

METATYPE · ELF

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

Pointed Ears. You hear from further away. Spend 1 edge to perceive beyond normal limits for several minutes (whispers in a noisy room, ultrasound).

Quick. You remain fast at normal load.

Graceful. When you resist a consequence of social pressure, it costs only 1 edge, regardless of the roll.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants. You consider chrome a flaw and let people notice. Instead you carry a high-end commlink and contact lenses with an AR overlay.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with charisma or conspiracy.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.

Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 1d

Engineer tech, tinkering

Interface Matrix, hacking

Stalk tracking, aiming

Survey observing, the scene

BODY · Body · Resistance 1d

Fight combat

Finesse dexterity, vehicles

Prowl sneaking, climbing

Wreck breaking, force

WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 3d

Command orders, threats

Consort rapport, contacts

Influence persuasion, deceit

Study analysis, spellcasting

EDGE push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma

Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious

HARM level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 3 needs help

LEVEL 2 -1d

LEVEL 1 less effect

ARMOR

LOAD

Face

smooth, connected, invited everywhere

Opens doors others would have to force: invitation, guest list, a conversation with Dr. Venn. The reason the crew gets into the glass elevator at all.

ELF · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Sprawl Whisperer START

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED

0 Fine Outfit • A suit of clothes that marks you as an executive, an officer of rank or the...

0 Fine Nightlife Subscription • Prepaid credit at the city’s popular clubs and restaurants.

1 Privacy Generator • A small tabletop device for a short conversation free of audio surveillance.

1 Street Drugs Up to three doses: Bluecoke, Glow, Nu-Ganja, Red Rock.

2 Extra Fine Outfit Like the Fine Outfit, one step more expensive: gala level.

0 An Entourage Three to five bodyguards, fans and retainers loyal only to you.

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

Foyer & security arch: With the Fine Outfit and a name from Ines you get waved through. Sprawl Whisperer gives the crew +1d on the engagement roll if you did your research.

Gallery & conservatory: Dr. Venn only talks to people who take art seriously. Consort 2 and Study 1 are enough to ask for a private viewing. The Privacy Generator buys five undisturbed minutes.

Lowering Alert: When a guard spots a deviation, you deliver the plausible explanation before they reach for the radio.

NUYEN start 2

STASH

FRIEND

Ines Okonkwo-Harada, gallerist. Curates in Bellevue and still owes Mercer. She can put a name on the guest list of the Vesperline gala or tell you which collectors are there tonight.

RIVAL

Tobias Wren, society reporter. Writes for a trid gossip channel, knows every face on the scene and once covered Mercer’s fall with relish. He is invited tonight.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You used to be inside: the invitations, the receptions, the right people. A scandal you did not cause threw you out. Six nuyen is good money, but the real payoff is one evening standing at the top again. And maybe the name behind it all.

SINs, elves and the price of existing. A SIN (System Identification Number) is more than an ID in the Sixth World: bank account, apartment, health insurance, the right to vote. Lose it and you officially stop existing. Mercer comes from Tír Tairngire, the elven nation south of Seattle, where bloodline decides careers. That Mercer now works with ork punks counts as a disgrace in the family.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Chameleon**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOK

HERITAGE

BACKGROUND

VICE

IDN (SIN)

CONTACTS

METATYPE • MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations to represent an easier life. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

An inconspicuous voice modulator in the larynx (changes pitch and accent) and a datajack behind the ear for simsense recordings from your trid days.

KARMA • PLAYBOOK TRACK

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with deception or information.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.

Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS • 7 DOTS • BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION • Intuition • Resistance 1d

Engineer

Interface

Stalk

Survey

BODY • Body • Resistance 2d

Fight

Finesse

Prowl

Wreck

WILLPOWER • Willpower • Resistance 3d

Command

Consort

Influence

Study

EDGE

HARM

ARMOR

LOAD

Snake

lies, manipulation, a thousand faces

Becomes someone who is allowed to be here: catering, insurance assessor, security. Fetches the keycard without anyone noticing it was fetched.

MENSCH • FEUERPROBE • RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Master of Disguise

GEAR • BOX = PACKED • • RECOMMENDED

1 Fine Disguise Kit

0 Fine Cover Identity

0 Concealed Holdout Pistol

0 Blackmail Supplies

0 Red Rock

1 Subterfuge Supplies

Standard anytime: Comm 0 • Armor 2 • Pistol 1 • Burglary Gear 1 • Climbing Gear 2 • Subterfuge Supplies 1 • Quiet Weapon 1 • Medieval Weapon 1 • Technical Tools 1 • Demolition Tools 2 • Lighting Gear 1 • Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

Garage & freight lobby:

Event office & hatch:

Guest restroom & locker room:

NUYEN

STASH

FRIEND

Nadia Feld, shift planner at Silberkante Catering.

RIVAL

Detective Marisol Ruiz, contracted police service.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

The bookies want their money and you have skipped town too often already.

Trideo, simsense and identities for sale. Trid is the television of the Sixth World: three-dimensional, everywhere, with stars more powerful than senators. Simsense goes further and plays feelings and senses straight into the brain. Anyone who was famous in this world knows how cheap identity is: on the black market a SIN costs less than a good dinner, but it only holds as long as nobody looks closely.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Kessel**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOK	Mid twenties, broad shoulders, braided hair with a data cable as jewelry. Hoodie covered in stickers, the cyberdeck belt underneath.
HERITAGE	North America · Puyallup, Seattle, grew up in the shadow of the Ash Pit
BACKGROUND	Academic · Matrix informatics at U-Dub, expelled in the third semester for rewriting the grading system
VICE	Obligation · two younger siblings in Puyallup whose school fees and clinic bills you pay
IDN (SIN)	Never had a real one. You built the fake SIN yourself; it survives every routine check and no targeted one.
CONTACTS	1337 Friends

METATYPE · ZWERG

Thermal Senses. Your senses detect nearby thermal signatures that are normally invisible.

Fun-sized. You are not fast at light load, but you remain inconspicuous at normal load. People underestimate you, and your stature.

Tenacious. You do not suffer a harm penalty until an entire row is filled.

Thiccblood. Alcohol does not linger. Resisting poison or disease costs only 1 edge.

IMPLANTS & BODY

Datajack at the left temple, cybereyes with image link and low-light amplifier. Your cyberdeck “Kessel” is soldered together from three corporate commlinks and carries a pendant from your sister.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

□ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with information or cybercrime.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.

Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 3d		□ □ □ □ □ □
Engineer tech, tinkering		● □ □ □ □
Interface Matrix, hacking		● ● □ □ □
Stalk tracking, aiming		□ □ □ □ □
Survey observing, the scene		● □ □ □ □
BODY · Body · Resistance 1d		□ □ □ □ □ □
Fight combat		□ □ □ □ □
Finesse dexterity, vehicles		□ □ □ □ □
Prowl sneaking, climbing		● □ □ □ □
Wreck breaking, force		□ □ □ □ □
WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 2d		□ □ □ □ □ □
Command orders, threats		□ □ □ □ □
Consort rapport, contacts		● □ □ □ □
Influence persuasion, deceit		□ □ □ □ □
Study analysis, spellcasting		● □ □ □ □
EDGE push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma		
□ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □		
□ □ □ □ Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid		
Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious		
HARM level 4 = fatal		
LEVEL 3 needs help	□ □ □ □ □ □ □ □	
LEVEL 2 -1d	□ □ □ □ □	□ □ □ □ □
LEVEL 1 less effect	□ □ □ □ □	□ □ □ □ □
ARMOR		
□ Armor	□ Heavy	
□ Special		
LOAD		
□ Light 3	□ Normal 5	
□ Heavy 6		

Hacker

digital spy and virtual weapon

Guest list, cameras, elevators, drones: anything with a network is your door. You see the building as a data flow and find the spot where it stalls.

ZWERG · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

- Search Protocol START**
- You are always aware of online devices in your presence. Take +1d when you gather information about high technology by any means.
- GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED**
- ☐ **1 A Scratch-Built Cyberdeck** • A modified comm that spots hidden data trails and quietly exploits them.
 - ☐ **0 Suite of WareZ** • Illegal apps for the cyberdeck: Armor, Arsenal, Breach, Mask.
 - ☐ **0 Blueprints** • A database of architectural and city plans.
 - ☐ **1 Fine Surveillance Gear** Signal scanner, wireless data taps, tracer tags, long-range audio and video...
 - ☐ **0 VR Trodes** A lightweight headband for entering virtual reality without a datajack.
 - ☐ **1 Portable VR Kit** A thin case with a seat and trodes: the safe corner from which you take over...

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Garage, building-control node:** From here you reach elevators, doors and the garage cameras. Not level 110, but you can make the freight elevator stop there.
- Security room & cameras:** Swap footage, mark a sensor as defective: that is how Alert drops again. Search Protocol tells you which drone is transmitting right now.
- Security server 110:** Physical access to doors, sensors and drone logic of the level. Controlled, but every login is logged: Heat after the run.

NUYEN start 2	STASH
□ □ □ □ □	□ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □

FRIEND

Glitch, former building-automation spider. Maintained the elevator controls of the Meridian Spire as a subcontractor. Knows the building-control node in the garage, the maintenance schedule of the facade gondola and the rule that the freight elevator does not stop at 110.

RIVAL

Nullpunkt, Matrix competition. Sells the same exploits to the same people, just an hour earlier. Claims Kessel's cyberdeck is “a toaster with ambitions”.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

The clinic in Puyallup keeps sending reminders. Six nuyen clears the rest. And Glitch said something that will not let you go: “Level 110 has its own host. Nobody builds that for art.”

The Matrix. The Matrix is everywhere: as augmented reality over the street, as virtual reality when you plug in via trodes or datajack. Corporations run hosts; their security hackers are called spiders. Break in and you risk biofeedback that injures the body. Deckers like Kessel build their tools from scrap because a legal cyberdeck costs more than an apartment in Bellevue.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Zephyr**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOK	Late thirties, sun-weathered, short hair, a flight jacket with the patches cut off. Control-rig jacks at the neck, always a tool belt at the hip.
HERITAGE	North America · Atlanta (CAS), drone missions for the UCAS Army, stuck in Seattle since
BACKGROUND	Military · reconnaissance and transport drones in the Desert Wars, dishonorably discharged after refusing an order
VICE	Stupor · cheap synth whisky at the hangar bar “Cap’s” at Everett field, at night when the memories get loud
IDN (SIN)	Your real military SIN was set to “killed in action” when you left. For everyday life you carry a fake civilian SIN.
CONTACTS	Handy Friends

METATYPE · MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

A control rig in the neck that links you directly to drones and vehicles. When you “rig”, your body slumps and breathes shallowly. Your left hand is a plain army-issue prosthesis.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with technical skill or control.
You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.
Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 4d		
Engineer tech, tinkering		
Interface Matrix, hacking		
Stalk tracking, aiming		
Survey observing, the scene		
BODY · Body · Resistance 1d		
Fight combat		
Finesse dexterity, vehicles		
Prowl sneaking, climbing		
Wreck breaking, force		
WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 0d		
Command orders, threats		
Consort rapport, contacts		
Influence persuasion, deceit		
Study analysis, spellcasting		
EDGE push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma		
Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid		
Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious		
HARM level 4 = fatal		
LEVEL 3 needs help		
LEVEL 2 -1d		
LEVEL 1 less effect		
ARMOR		
Armor	Heavy	
Special		
LOAD		
Light 3	Normal 5	
Heavy 6		

Rigger

technology, flying skill, control over every machine

Air route, facade gondola, skycab, drones in the shaft: where others look for a door, you see a flight corridor. You get the crew up and back down.

MENSCH · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Ace START

You can Finesse a vehicle to take off, control or land it, regardless of its means of propulsion. You gain potency when you make difficult maneuvers while piloting a vehicle.

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED

- 0

A Configured Drone • “Dragonfly”: a palm-sized rotor drone with camera and microphone, fits through...
- 0

A Personal Vehicle • A heavy motorcycle with sidecar, waiting at the VIP drop-off or the ramp.
- 1

Utility Harness • Three chemicals or gadgets: Hypersolvent, Hyperglue, Thermite Gel,...
- 1

Medical Supplies Three sprays or patches: Antidote Patch, Hard-Clot, Sterilizer, Stim Patch,...
- 1

Fine Electrical Tools Soldering irons, special wrenches, precision sensors, a headlamp with...

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Roof & skycab pad:** With Ace and Cap you come in from above. The approach transponder grants hacked skycabs landing clearance; without clearance the cab circles and calls in.
- Facade gondola:** Control box on the roof, docking point on 110. Finesse 2 for the ride in the wind, Vehicular Override from the Utility Harness for the electronics.
- Drone shaft:** “Dragonfly” flies from the garage to the kitchen on 111 and up to the roof. Gear in portions, eyes everywhere, and nobody asks a delivery drone for an invitation.

NUYEN start 2

STASH

FRIEND

“Cap” Okafor, tilt-rotor pilot. Flies freight routes over the Sound and is not afraid of a pass at 400 meters. She drops the crew above the roof or picks them up again at the east facade.

RIVAL

Dispatcher Vance, Seattle skycab control. Once caught Zephyr rerouting a skycab without clearance. He knows the control rig’s signature and reports it with pleasure.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You want your old reconnaissance drone back; a scrap dealer in Tacoma holds it for twelve nuyen. Six is a start. And this run has altitude, wind and a tower that deserves a proper approach.

Riggers, drones and corporate wars. A control rig links the nervous system directly to machines: whoever rigs feels the rotor like their own hand. Such implants cost Essence, a piece of humanity that cannot be bought back. The Desert Wars are the televised wars of the corporations, mercenaries fighting in front of cameras. Anyone who flew there knows the difference between a target and a person.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Bastion**

NAME	PRONOUNS
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PROFILE

LOOK 2.40 m, calm movements, one horn sawn off (the other polished). Dark coat over a bulletproof vest, a voice like a refrigerator starting up.

HERITAGE Europe · Hamburg (Allied German States), brought to Seattle ten years ago on a security contract

BACKGROUND Law · twelve years of corporate security and close protection at Sentinel Solutions, fired for refusing a shoot order

VICE Obligation · your ex and your daughter in Tacoma, whose school fees you transfer on time, whatever it costs

IDN (SIN) A real corporate SIN from Sentinel Solutions, expired with the dismissal. Never replaced, so every checkpoint is a problem.

CONTACTS Dangerous Friends

METATYPE · TROLL

Thermal Senses. Your senses detect nearby thermal signatures.

Oversized. You are never inconspicuous (not even at light load), but you are not slower at heavy load and carry +1 load. People fear your kind.

Troll Armor. Skin and bones are hardened: one extra armor box and +1d on resistance rolls with Body.

Horned. Horns as weapons. You had one removed; the other makes people nervous.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants, on principle. “I have seen enough chrome in faces that felt nothing anymore.” Kevlar under the coat instead, and a security license that still looks real.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK
□□□□□□□□□□

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with violence or coercion.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.

Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 1d	□□□□□□
Engineer tech, tinkering	□□□□
Interface Matrix, hacking	□□□□
Stalk tracking, aiming	□□□□
Survey observing, the scene	●□□□

BODY · Body · Resistance 2d	□□□□□□
Fight combat	●●□□
Finesse dexterity, vehicles	□□□□
Prowl sneaking, climbing	□□□□
Wreck breaking, force	●□□□

WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 3d	□□□□□□
Command orders, threats	●□□□
Consort rapport, contacts	●□□□
Influence persuasion, deceit	□□□□
Study analysis, spellcasting	●□□□

EDGE push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma

□□□□□□□□□□

□□□□ Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid

Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious

HARM level 4 = fatal	
LEVEL 3 needs help	
LEVEL 2 -1d	
LEVEL 1 less effect	

ARMOR	LOAD
☐ Armor ☐ Heavy	☐ Light 3 ☐ Normal 5
☐ Special	☐ Heavy 6

Muscle

dangerous, intimidating, the crew’s shield

Stands between the crew and whatever goes wrong. Knows how security people think because you were one. Masters violence instead of needing it.

TROLL · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Bodyguard START

When you protect a teammate, take +1d to your resistance roll. When you gather information to anticipate possible threats in the current situation, you get +1 effect.

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED

☐ 1 Light Armor • Lighter and less conspicuous than normal armor, with a (real or forged)...
☐ 1 Fine Scary Weapon/Tool • Shock gloves: more effect when you intimidate, not more harm.
☐ 0 Containment Manacles • Self-latching manacles with impact-resistant chain.
☐ 2 Fine Brutal Weapon A devastating heavy weapon, here a shotgun from Sentinel stock.
☐ 0 Kamikaze Vial Combat drug: strength, pain tolerance, rage for minutes.
☐ 1 A Medieval Weapon • Standard: a telescopic baton.

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Foyer & security arch:** Light Armor with a license plus Oversized means: they see you, but they expect you too. As a hired bodyguard of a guest you are plausible.
- Drone node 110:** Guardian drones block first and shoot last. Bodyguard gives you +1d when you put yourself in front of the crew and +1 effect when you read their states.
- Kade:** You know his routine, his twitches, his pride. Consort or Command to read him, Survey to predict his rounds. As long as he does not see you.

NUYEN start 2	STASH
□□□□	□□□□□□□□□□
	□□□□□□□□□□

FRIEND

Doc Amsel, street doctor in Tacoma. Patches up runners without questions and amputated Bastion’s horn. She knows every bodyguard in town who is on duty at a gala tonight.

RIVAL

Dorian Kade, head of security at the gala. Was Bastion’s team leader at Sentinel Solutions and signed the dismissal. Kade has a memory for faces and two chromed arms Bastion never liked.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You need the money for Tacoma, but you take the job because Mr. Johnson said: no network. A run where nobody dies, in a tower Kade guards. You want to prove that security can be beaten without a shoot order.

Trolls, goblinization and corporate security. In 2021 people all over the world turned into orks and trolls overnight: goblinization. Trolls are strong, armored and live with doors, chairs and prejudices not built for them. Corporations like hiring them as security and dislike giving them responsibility. A troll who refuses a shoot order is a legend in the shadows and an HR case in Bellevue.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Fizz**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOK 19, wiry, neon-green streaks, tusk caps made from spray-can aluminium. Hoodie, climbing gloves, hoverboard under one arm. You chew gum constantly.

HERITAGE North America · Redmond Barrens, Seattle. Never been further than Bellevue, and only to steal.

BACKGROUND Underworld · courier runs and climbing for the Rusted Halos, a go-gang you left when the leader started killing

VICE Pleasure · rooftop parties above Glow City, adrenaline, loud music, anything that tastes like life

IDN (SIN) None. Never had one. To you the city is a climbing wall without ID checks.

CONTACTS Shady Friends

METATYPE · ORK

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

Foolish Pride. Regain 1 edge when you roll a critical on a desperate action roll.

Numbskull. Spend 1 edge to ignore a harm penalty (including incapacitation) for an action.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants, but you would love cybereyes. Instead a scratched commlink with a climbing app, gecko gloves and a hoverboard with hand-sprayed flames.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

□□□□□□□□□□

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with surprise or mayhem.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.

Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 1d

□□□□□□

Engineer
tech, tinkering

□□□□

Interface
Matrix, hacking

□□□□

Stalk
tracking, aiming

□□□□

Survey
observing, the scene

●□□□

BODY · Body · Resistance 4d

□□□□□□

Fight
combat

●□□□

Finesse
dexterity, vehicles

●□□□

Prowl
sneaking, climbing

●●□□

Wreck
breaking, force

●□□□

WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 1d

□□□□□□

Command
orders, threats

□□□□

Consort
rapport, contacts

□□□□

Influence
persuasion, deceit

●□□□

Study
analysis, spellcasting

□□□□

EDGE

push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma

□□□□□□□□□□

□□□□ Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid

Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious

HARM

level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 3
needs help

LEVEL 2
-1d

LEVEL 1
less effect

ARMOR

□ Armor □ Heavy □ Special

LOAD

□ Light 3 □ Normal 5 □ Heavy 6

Punk

wily, streetwise, chaos with a plan

Takes the routes that officially do not exist: access ladder, maintenance shaft, glass roof, ceiling void. Creates distractions when things get hot, and is the first one back outside.

ORK · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Catch Me If You Can **START**

You may expend your special armor to resist a consequence from detection or security measures, or to push yourself for a feat of escape or stealth.

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · ● RECOMMENDED

- ☐ **1 Gecko Gloves** ● Nanofiber gloves with extreme adhesion: climb smooth and vertical surfaces,...
- ☐ **1 Fine Stealth Outfit** ● A full bodysuit of smart cloth that blends you into the darkness.
- ☐ **1 Explosives** ● Three electronic bombs on a strap: Bangflash, EMP Grenade, Pepper Smoke, Tear...
- ☐ **0 Stunlock Vial** ● Tranquilizer for an hour of sleep.
- ☐ **1 Fine Punk Stuff** A small hoverboard for tricks, with graphics of your choice.
- ☐ **2 Climbing Gear** Standard: grappling hooks, suction gloves, carabiners.

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Access ladder & maintenance shaft:** From the terrace on 111 to the roof, from the roof down the shaft to 110, without touching the party. Catch Me If You Can pays for the moment a sensor trips after all.
- Ceiling void:** From the locker room over the partition wall into the event office. Tight, dark, exactly your thing. The keycard lies below in its box.
- Distraction:** Pepper smoke in the salon, a guest falls into the pool, a tray tips over: you buy the crew the two minutes in which nobody is watching.

NUYEN start 2

□□□□

STASH

□□□□□□□□□□
□□□□□□□□□□

FRIEND

Mondo, facade cleaner for the maintenance firm. Rides the Meridian Spire's gondola every Tuesday. He tells you where the control box sits, when the schedule calls for a run and that the terrace camera only sees the drone pad.

RIVAL

Ripfang, leader of the Rusted Halos. Takes it personally that Fizz left. His gang controls the streets around the approach to Bellevue.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

Your little brother Teo is eleven and starting to think the Rusted Halos are cool. Six nuyen is an apartment outside the Barrens. Besides: 112 floors of glass. You have never seen anything that tall that you have not climbed.

The Barrens, go-gangs and life without a SIN. Redmond used to be a tech suburb. Today the Barrens are a district without power, police or garbage collection, where gangs are the order. Those born here often have no SIN: no school, no doctor, no way out except the shadows. Orks are born where humans move away. Fizz does not consider that fate, but a wall you can climb.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Hush**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOK	Early thirties, slim, very upright, short black hair. Plain dark clothes without logos; fine white tattoos on neck and the backs of the hands that glow in astral space.
HERITAGE	Asia · Seoul, moved to Seattle with your parents as a child; grew up between two languages and a dojo
BACKGROUND	Academic · dropped philosophy, taught martial arts for ten years, then security consulting until too many contracts raised questions
VICE	Faith · meditation at Master Oyelaran’s dojo in Georgetown. You call it discipline; it is an addiction to stillness.
IDN (SIN)	A real, unremarkable SIN. You are registered, pay taxes and exist for the state as someone who teaches martial arts.
CONTACTS	Strange Friends

METATYPE · MENSCH

Mensch. No special traits. By the rules you may instead pick up to two free permutations. Talk it over with the GM or skip it.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants: cyberware would weaken your magic. Your tattoos are Fine Mystic Body Art, a focus that carries your way.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

□□□□□□□□□□

Playbook: You addressed a tough challenge with inner perfection or mystical power.
You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background.
Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 2d	□□□□□□
Engineer tech, tinkering	○○○○○
Interface Matrix, hacking	○○○○○
Stalk tracking, aiming	●○○○○
Survey observing, the scene	●○○○○

BODY · Body · Resistance 3d	□□□□□□
Fight combat	●○○○○
Finesse dexterity, vehicles	●○○○○
Prowl sneaking, climbing	●●○○○
Wreck breaking, force	○○○○○

WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 1d	□□□□□□
Command orders, threats	○○○○○
Consort rapport, contacts	○○○○○
Influence persuasion, deceit	○○○○○
Study analysis, spellcasting	●○○○○

EDGE	push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma
□□□□□□□□□□	
□□□□	Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid
	Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious

HARM	level 4 = fatal
LEVEL 3 needs help	□□□□□□□□
LEVEL 2 -1d	□□□□ □□□□
LEVEL 1 less effect	□□□□ □□□□

ARMOR	☐ Armor ☐ Heavy ☐ Light 3 ☐ Normal 5 ☐ Special ☐ Heavy 6
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Adept

magic in the body, perfection as a path

Moves where sensors stand and senses danger before it arrives. Reads people like a pulse. Solves conflicts with a grip instead of a bullet.

MENSCH · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Practitioner of the Way REQUIRED

Way of the Body (Fight, Finesse, Prowl, Wreck): three of your starting dots lie there. You resist supernatural consequences with Body. You can never become Awakened or Emergent. Choose an adept drawback from the rulebook.

Adept Senses START

Spend 1 edge to perceive beyond normal limits for several minutes. Detect subtle environmental changes (temperature, frequency, pressure), sense the presence of danger, become a living lie detector.

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED

- ☐ 0 **Fine Mystic Body Art** • Tattoos that focus your adept core.
- ☐ 0 **Strange Trinket** • A small item, here a worn prayer chain, that shows visions of the past or near...
- ☐ 2 **Fine Astral Weapon** A short staff effective against astral beings.
- ☐ 1 **A Quiet Weapon** • Standard: throwing knives or a blowgun with tranquilizer darts.
- ☐ 2 **Climbing Gear** Standard: grappling hooks and carabiners in case Prowl 2 is not enough for once.

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Sensor corridor 110:** Adept Senses feel light barriers as warmth, pressure plates as unevenness, cameras as a hum. Prowl 2 carries you through.
- Dr. Venn:** As a living lie detector you notice her turning suspicious before she shows it. Study to read her; Finesse to capture the iris scan unnoticed.
- Conservatory glass roof:** The vent flap sticks mechanically, no sensor. Five meters of rope into soft plants is a step for you.

NUYEN start 2	STASH
□□□□	□□□□□□□□□□
	□□□□□□□□□□

FRIEND

Master Oyelaran, dojo owner in Georgetown. Trains half of Seattle’s security industry. He knows which guards stand in the Spire tonight, which of them are augmented and who gets careless after a 14-hour day.

RIVAL

Aurel Voss, adept in the service of a corporate security firm. Once trained beside Hush and considers this path a weakness. He advises security companies in Bellevue, occasionally Vesperline too.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

You seek tasks that make you grow. A tower full of sensors, drones and a curator who must not be harmed is a test of your discipline. The money goes to the dojo. The test is yours.

The Awakening and the adepts. Magic has been back in the world since 2011. About one in a hundred people is Awakened: mages cast and summon, adepts channel mana into their own bodies and become faster, more alert, harder, without anyone seeing it. Cyberware and magic do not mix: every implant costs Essence and weakens the gift. Adepts like Hush therefore choose the body they have and make it the weapon.

STREET NAME **Suggestion: Ravn**

NAME

PRONOUNS

PROFILE

LOOKMid forties, greying temples, strong polished tusks. Tweed jacket, reading glasses with a sensing focus, a ring of meteoric iron on the little finger.

HERITAGEEurope · Kraków, transferred to Seattle on a corporate contract and stayed

BACKGROUNDCorporate · wage mage in a corporation’s magical security: check barriers, banish spirits, do not ask questions. You asked.

VICEWeird · conversations with “Vesna”, a free spirit living in the empty library at Pike Place who only answers in rhymes

IDN (SIN)Your corporate SIN was deleted with the dismissal. You live on a fake SIN, occupation: independent scholar.

CONTACTSStrange Friends

METATYPE · ORK

Low-light Vision. You can see in low light as well as if it were well lit.

Foolish Pride. Regain 1 edge when you roll a critical on a desperate action roll.

Numbskull. Spend 1 edge to ignore a harm penalty (including incapacitation) for an action.

IMPLANTS & BODY

No implants: every piece of chrome would weaken your magic. Your foci glasses and ring.

KARMA · PLAYBOOK TRACK

Playbook: You addressed a challenge with knowledge or magical power.

You expressed your beliefs, heritage or background. Your vice or trauma caused you trouble.

TWO SPELLS LEARNED

Stunbolt
A surge of mana against a target’s mind: unconsciousness instead of wounds. Non-lethal, silent, visible only to the Awakened. Study, line of sight.

Veil
An illusion over a person or thing: different clothes, another face, a case that looks like a briefcase. Lasts as long as you concentrate. It fools people, not cameras.

ACTIONS · 7 DOTS · BOXES = KARMA TRACKS

INTUITION · Intuition · Resistance 1d

Engineer
tech, tinkering

Interface
Matrix, hacking

Stalk
tracking, aiming

Survey
observing, the scene

BODY · Body · Resistance 1d

Fight
combat

Finesse
dexterity, vehicles

Prowl
sneaking, climbing

Wreck
breaking, force

WILLPOWER · Willpower · Resistance 3d

Command
orders, threats

Consort
rapport, contacts

Influence
persuasion, deceit

Study
analysis, spellcasting

Assense
perceive astrally, read barriers and spirits
ÜBERNATÜRLICH

EDGE

push 2 · assist 1 · full = trauma

Cold Haunted Obsessed Paranoid

Reckless Soft Unstable Vicious

HARM

level 4 = fatal

LEVEL 3
needs help

LEVEL 2
-1d

LEVEL 1
less effect

ARMOR

Armor Heavy Special

LOAD

Light 3 Normal 5 Heavy 6

Mage

Awakened, hermetic, a view into astral space

Sees what nobody else sees: barriers, watchers, magical auras, the case among a hundred objects. Casts quietly and knows how corporate mages think.

ORK · FEUERPROBE · RUNNERS IN THE SHADOWS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Awakened REQUIRED
Arcane method: hermetic tradition (choose drawbacks per the rulebook). You may roll the Assense action; when you roll a desperate Assense action, mark 1 karma on the Willpower track. Buy further Assense dots as a Willpower advance. Never Emergent or an adept.

Sorcerer START
You know the unique methods to activate metaplanar energies through your body to cast spells. You can Study a spell formula to summon a supernatural effect. You begin with two spells already learned.

GEAR · BOX = PACKED · • RECOMMENDED

1 Fine Spell Focus • The ring of meteoric iron: wield spells with exceptional control.

1 Fine Sensing Focus • Glasses through which you see arcane energies in great detail.

0 Banishing Focus • A small arcane amulet that astral beings prefer to avoid.

1 Fine Arcane Reagents Grave dust, prayer beads, awakened feathers: concentrated essence for big...

0 A Paracritter An awakened animal as a companion (cohort, expert).

Standard anytime: Comm 0 · Armor 2 · Pistol 1 · Burglary Gear 1 · Climbing Gear 2 · Subterfuge Supplies 1 · Quiet Weapon 1 · Medieval Weapon 1 · Technical Tools 1 · Demolition Tools 2 · Lighting Gear 1 · Ammo 1

HOW YOU SHINE IN THE MERIDIAN SPIRE

- Vault 110:** Assense shows you the dual mana barrier, the living tissue and the watcher on its rounds. At the doorway you see how the barrier is opened in a controlled way: an advantage for any way in of your own.
- The collection:** The case carries a faint, old aura. Among a hundred glittering things it is the only one that whispers to you. You also see which antiques are magical and which are merely expensive.
- Stunbolt & Veil:** A guard sleeps, a runner looks like staff, the case looks like a briefcase. Non-lethal, silent, exactly as Johnson demanded.

NUYEN start 2

STASH

FRIEND

Talia Vance, talismonger in Tacoma. Deals in foci and reagents and hears everything Seattle’s Awakened gossip about. She has heard that the barrier in the Meridian Spire was drawn by a master nobody knows.

RIVAL

Dr. Henrik Solvay, Ravn’s former supervisor. Still runs the magical security of the former corporation and has marked Ravn’s file “unreliable, monitor whereabouts”.

WHY YOU TAKE THIS JOB

For twelve years you drew barriers for people who never told you what lay behind them. Now, for once, you want to know what is behind a wall built this well. The nuyen pay for Vesna’s library. The curiosity you pay yourself.

Hermetics, astral space and dragons.

Awakened mages follow traditions: hermetics treat magic as a science of formulas and circles, shamans as a relationship with spirits and mentors. Astral space is the second layer of the world, where thoughts have colors and barriers stand like walls. At the very top stand the Great Dragons: ancient, unimaginably rich, seated on corporate boards. Some walls were not built for people.